“After death we become spirits floating forever.”

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Where it often comes from

Cartoons and movies showing people as ghosts on clouds. Funeral sayings that focus only on the soul. Never learning about the resurrection of the body. Ideas borrowed from other religions or philosophies. Finding a bodiless eternity hard to look forward to.

What Scripture teaches

Believers who die are with the Lord, but that is not the final chapter. Scripture promises a bodily resurrection. After He rose, Jesus said, “Touch Me and see—for a spirit does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have.” He is the firstfruits of all who will rise. Our bodies will be raised imperishable, glorious, and powerful, and God will make a new heaven and a new earth where He will dwell with His people. Our future is not floating; it is resurrection life.

> *“Look at My hands and My feet. It is I Myself. Touch Me and see—for a spirit does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have”* **(Luke 24:39)**.

Also see

> “But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep” **(1 Corinthians 15:20)**.

> “So will it be with the resurrection of the dead: What is sown is perishable; it is raised imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body” **(1 Corinthians 15:42–44)**.

> “But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body” **(Philippians 3:20–21)**.

> “Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying: ‘Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man, and He will dwell with them. They will be His people, and God Himself will be with them as their God.’” **(Revelation 21:1–3)**.

Common self-statements

- We’ll just be spirits in the sky.
- Eternity sounds empty and unreal.
- I won’t have a body anymore.
- Heaven will be vague and shadowy.
- The physical world doesn’t matter forever.
- I can’t imagine what forever will be like.

Common logical errors

- **Borrowed ideas:** Accepting cultural pictures of the afterlife instead of Scripture’s.
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking the promise of resurrection and a new earth.

- **Vagueness:** Settling for a fuzzy picture that makes eternity hard to love.
- **Fortune telling:** Assuming eternity will be empty or unreal.

Challenging questions

- What did Jesus show His disciples after He rose?
- What does it mean that Christ is the firstfruits?
- How does 1 Corinthians 15 describe the resurrection body?
- What will Jesus do with our lowly bodies?
- What does God promise to make new?
- Where did my picture of floating spirits come from?
- How does the hope of resurrection change how I see eternity?

Truth summary

> After death, believers are with the Lord, and one day we will be raised with real, glorious bodies like Jesus' resurrection body. God will make a new heaven and a new earth and dwell with His people. My future is not floating forever; it is resurrection life with Christ.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Christ, Resurrection of
- Eternal Life
- Heaven
- Death/Dying
- Second Coming

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Christ, Who He Is

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "After death we become spirits floating forever"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"After death we become spirits floating forever." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did Jesus show after He rose?
- ☐ What does "firstfruits" mean for me?
- ☐ How is the resurrection body described?
- ☐ What will Jesus do with my body?
- ☐ What will God make new?
- ☐ Where did my picture of floating come from?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus rose with a real body, and so will I.
- ☐ Christ is the firstfruits of those who will rise.
- ☐ My body will be raised imperishable and glorious.
- ☐ God will make a new heaven and a new earth.
- ☐ God will dwell with His people.
- ☐ My future is resurrection life.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Luke 24:39**
  "Look at My hands and My feet. It is I Myself. Touch Me and see—for a spirit does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:20**
  "But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:42–44**
  "So will it be with the resurrection of the dead: What is sown is perishable; it is raised imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body."
- [ ] **Philippians 3:20–21**
  "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body."
- [ ] **Revelation 21:1–3**
  "Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying: 'Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man, and He will dwell with them. They will be His people, and God Himself will be with them as their God.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Resurrection hope journal:** Each day, write one thing I look forward to about resurrection life.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Philippians 3:20–21 becomes: "But **Sarah's** citizenship is in heaven, and **she** eagerly awaits a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who will transform **her** lowly body to be like His glorious body."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Christ, Resurrection of" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Luke 24:36–43,** and list every physical detail about Jesus' risen body.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 15 straight through,** and underline what our bodies will be like.
- ☐ **Read Revelation 21–22,** and write down three things about the new earth.
- ☐ **Share the hope of resurrection** with someone who is grieving.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "After death we become spirits floating forever": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One resurrection hope I thought about
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~After death we become spirits floating forever.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You that You rose from the dead with a real body and that I will be raised too. Help me reject the idea that after death we become spirits floating forever. Fill me with hope for resurrection life and for the new heaven and new earth where You will dwell with us. In Your name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.